

Analyzing the Body of Phishing Emails

Intro:

Phishing attacks are one of the most common and effective methods used by cybercriminals to compromise individuals and organizations. As a cybersecurity analyst, my ability to detect and understand phishing emails is critical to preventing data breaches, financial loss, and reputational damage. Phishing emails often appear harmless or legitimate, which is why I find it essential to analyze the subtle indicators hidden within the email body.

Why It's Important:

Phishing emails are designed to deceive users into disclosing sensitive information or downloading malicious attachments. While some phishing attacks may seem obvious to me, I know that attackers are becoming increasingly sophisticated—they make their emails look authentic by mimicking trusted brands, colleagues, or service providers. If I fail to recognize these emails, it can lead to widespread security incidents, credential theft, or malware infections across the organization.

Key Elements I Analyze:

As I examine the body of a phishing email, I consistently watch for several red flags and patterns:

1. **Language and Tone:** I look for urgent language that pressures the recipient to act quickly, such as clicking a link or providing personal information. I pay close attention to excessive urgency or threats, as legitimate organizations typically avoid these tactics.
2. **Spelling and Grammar:** I check for spelling or grammatical errors. While attackers are improving their techniques, sloppy language is still a telltale sign, especially when the email claims to be from a professional organization.
3. **Suspicious Links or Attachments:** I always hover over links to verify their legitimacy and check for hidden or unusual URLs. Attachments also get my full scrutiny, particularly unexpected formats like .exe, .zip, or even malicious PDFs and Word documents.
4. **Sender Information:** I examine the sender's email address closely, what looks legitimate at first glance often reveals inconsistencies, such as slight misspellings or unusual domains. Since phishing emails frequently spoof trusted contacts, I never skip this step.
5. **Requests for Sensitive Information:** I keep in mind that legitimate companies will never ask for passwords, credit card details, or other sensitive information via email. If an email requests such data, I immediately flag it as a strong indicator of a phishing attempt.

My Observations on the Impact of AI

I've observed how AI has significantly enhanced the ability of cybercriminals to craft more sophisticated and convincing phishing emails. With AI-driven tools, attackers can easily generate personalized messages by scraping public data from social media and other platforms, tailoring emails to resonate with a recipient's interests, profession, or affiliations. Additionally, AI allows

them to automate campaigns at scale, minimizing the spelling and grammar mistakes that once served as clear red flags. These tools can mimic writing styles and replicate legitimate company templates with precision, making phishing emails much harder for me to detect. As AI continues to evolve, I recognize that these attacks are becoming more difficult to spot, which only emphasizes the need for advanced threat detection and continuous user awareness.

Conclusion

By honing my ability to spot these red flags, I strengthen my defenses against phishing attacks and better protect my organization's assets. As I dive deeper into analyzing phishing email bodies, I always remind myself that attackers are continually evolving their tactics—and staying vigilant is key to effective threat mitigation.

The remainder of this walkthrough covers examples of email bodies from the phishing training company **Caniphish**. Here is my personal breakdown of each one.

Netflix Password Expiry

Netflix is a service that requires no introduction. Originally founded as a DVD rental service in 1997, it transitioned to streaming in 2007. As of 2023, Netflix boasts approximately 238 million subscribers globally, making it one of the largest streaming platforms in the world.



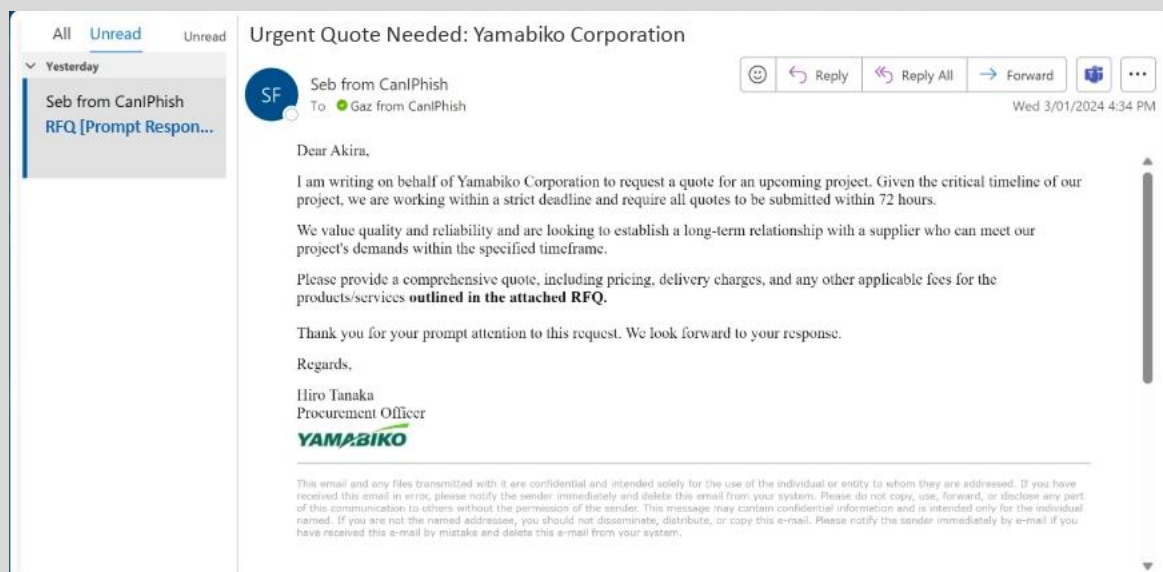
- **My assessment of this email:** This email claims to be from Netflix, warning the recipient that their password is due to expire soon and urging them to reset it immediately due to a purported increase in account compromises. It includes a "Reset Password" link, which I recognize as a phishing attempt to steal Netflix login credentials.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** The email mimics legitimate security alerts from Netflix, incorporating typical language about account security and urgent action. It uses a

direct and personal tone, referring to the Netflix team as "Your friends at Netflix," which can make the communication feel authentic. The inclusion of standard footer links (Settings, Terms of Use, Privacy, Help Centre) similar to genuine Netflix emails adds to the deception.

- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Netflix subscribers, especially those who may not be aware of how legitimate password reset processes are typically handled, are most susceptible.

Request For Quote

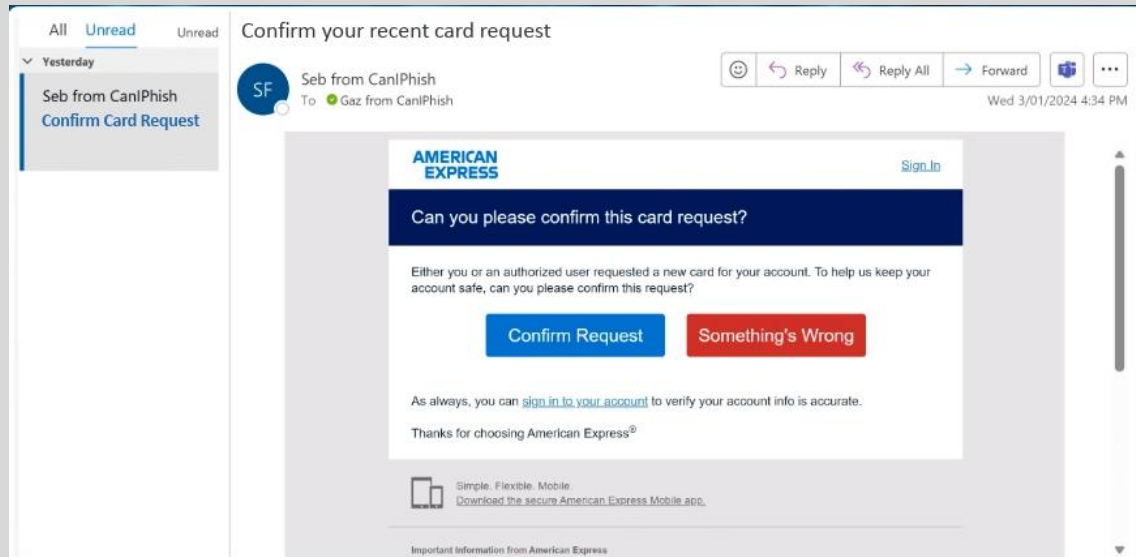
Request for Quote (RFQ) phishing emails are a sophisticated scam where attackers pose as potential clients requesting quotes for services. These emails appear urgent and professional.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email appears to be a professional request from Yamabiko Corporation for a quote on an upcoming project, emphasizing a critical timeline and the need for a swift response. It requests a comprehensive quote, including pricing and delivery charges, in response to the attached Request for Quotation (RFQ).
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It is crafted to look like typical business communication, complete with the name and position of a procurement officer and a formal tone discussing project requirements and timelines. The detailed instructions, sense of urgency, confidentiality notices, and professional language all add to its appearance of legitimacy.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Business professionals, particularly those in sales, supply chain, or procurement roles, are most at risk. Individuals who handle supplier communications and are used to receiving RFQs are especially vulnerable.

Amex Card Confirmation

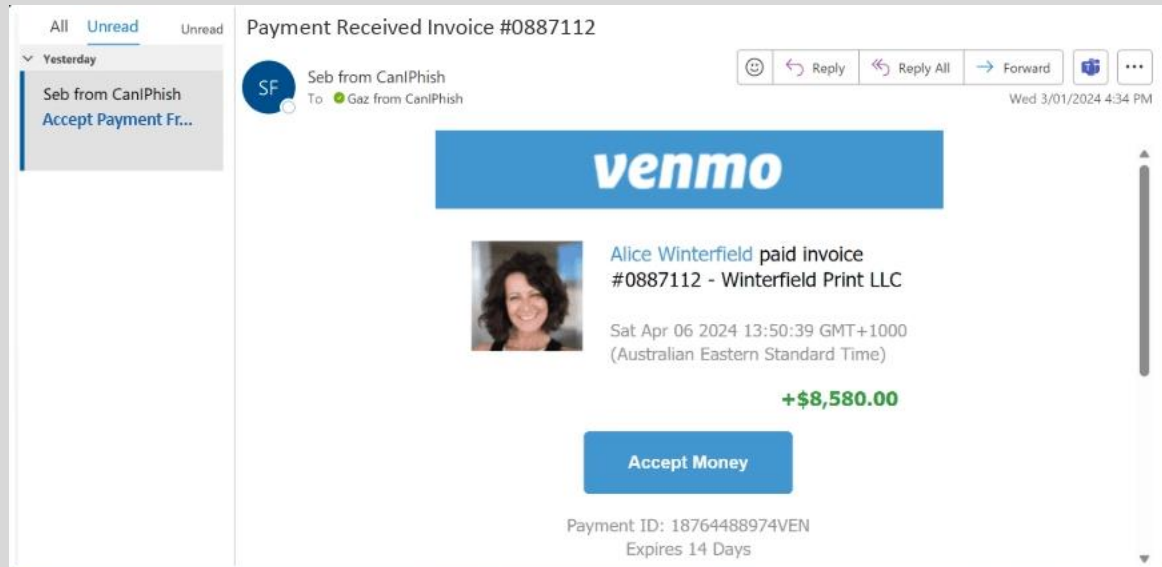
American Express (Amex) is a global financial services corporation best known for its credit cards. Amex cards are used by approximately 114 million cardholders worldwide.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email purports to be a notification from American Express, indicating that either the recipient or an authorized user has requested a new card. It includes links to confirm the request or to indicate something is wrong, as well as a general link to sign into the account.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It successfully imitates the official communication style of American Express, complete with service marks, privacy policies, and contact options. It addresses security concerns directly by asking the recipient to confirm a transaction common legitimate practice, which enhances its believability. The professional design and detailed footer add layers of perceived legitimacy.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** American Express cardholders, especially those who frequently manage their accounts online or expect communications from the company.

Venmo Payment Notification

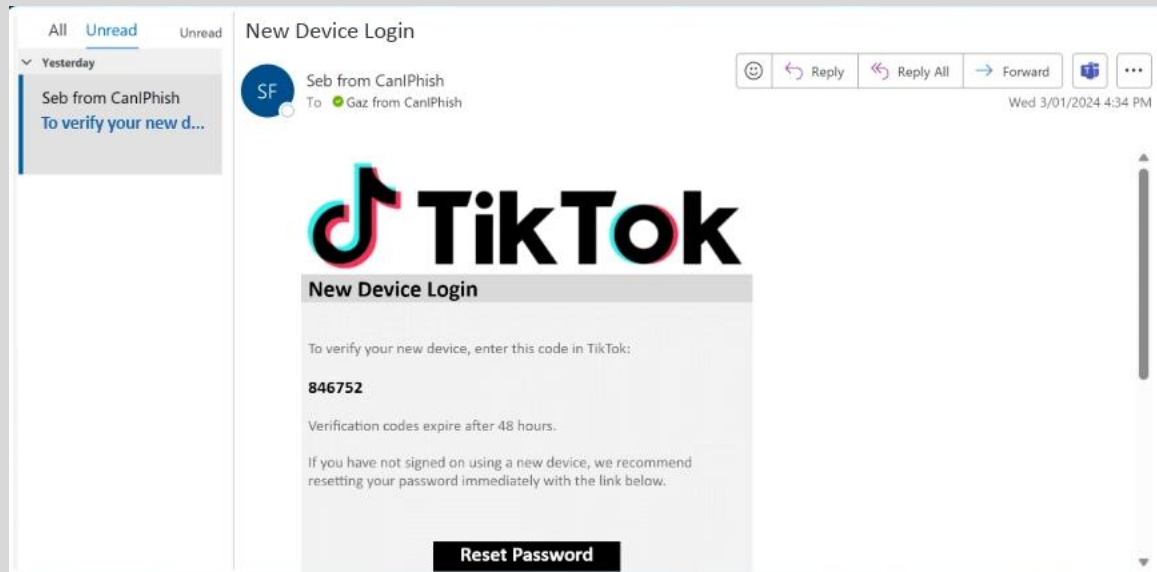
Venmo is a digital wallet that lets users make and share payments and is increasingly used by small businesses.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email presents itself as a notification from Venmo, indicating that the recipient has received a substantial amount of money. It prompts them to "Accept Money" through a provided link, a classic phishing setup aimed at capturing Venmo credentials.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** The email uses a plausible Venmo transaction format, including specific details like invoice numbers, payment amounts, and deadlines for accepting the money. It mimics Venmo's branding and communication style, complete with contact information and an address.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Venmo users, particularly those who use the service for business transactions or frequently receive payments. Individuals expecting payments might quickly click the link hoping to claim funds.

TikTok New Device

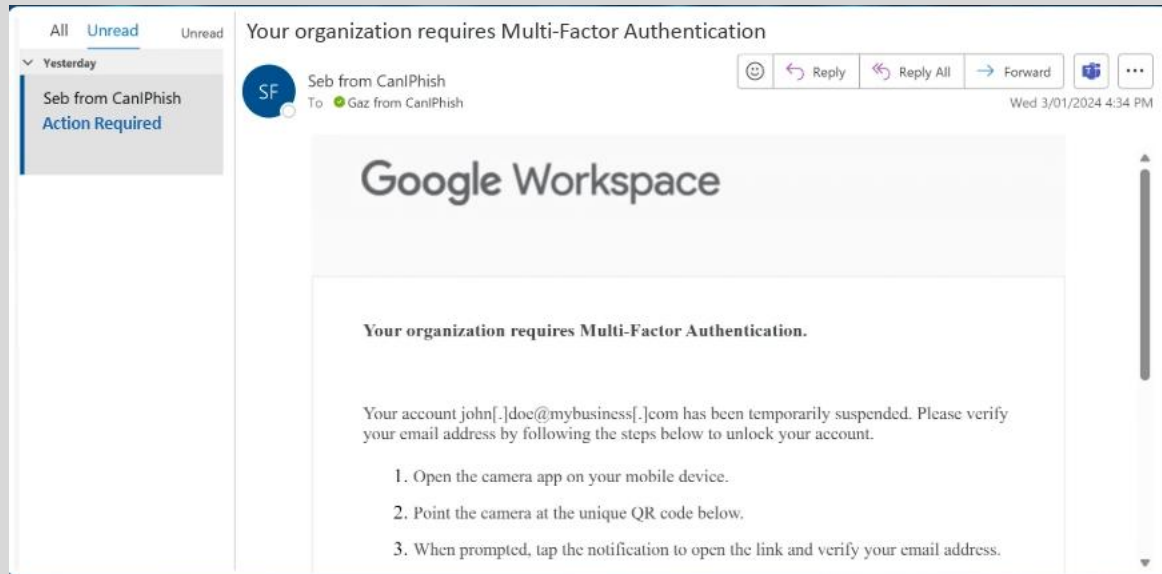
TikTok, launched in 2016, is a social media platform especially popular among Gen Z users.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email claims to be a security alert from TikTok, notifying the recipient about a login from a new device and providing a verification code. It also includes a "Reset Password" link as a precautionary step.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It pretends to be a security notification complete with a verification code and urgent security recommendations. It uses official language, adds links to support resources, and includes the correct contact details and privacy policy links.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** TikTok users, especially those who are active and have linked personal or business accounts. Users are conscious about securing their accounts may be deceived into clicking the phishing link.

Google Workspace QR Code

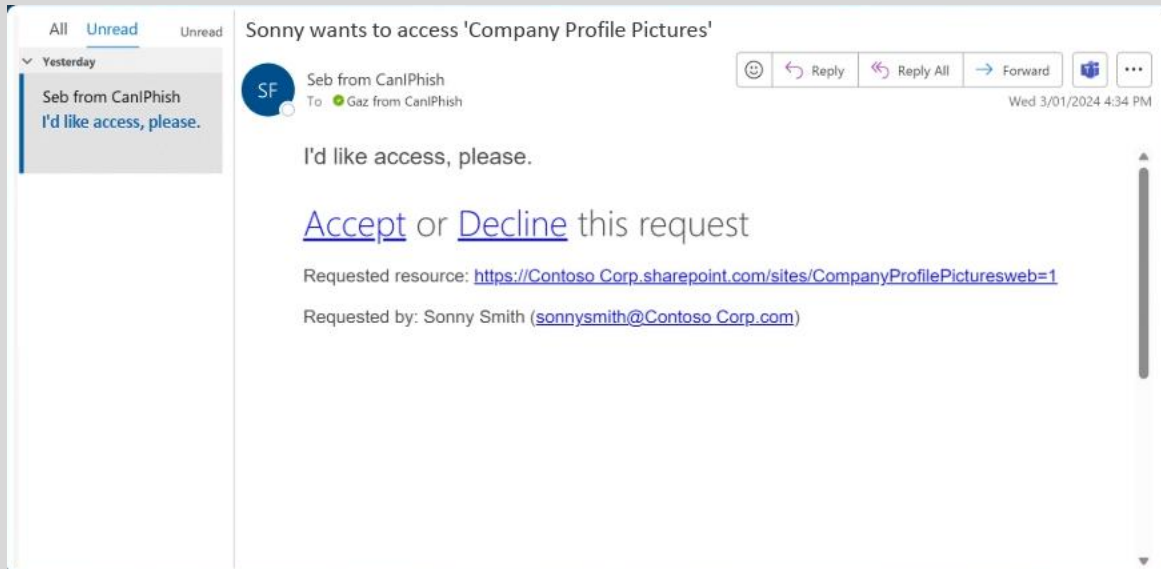
Google Workspace is a collection of cloud computing, productivity, and collaboration tools developed by Google.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is crafted to appear as a security notification from Google Workspace, claiming the recipient's account has been suspended and requires Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) verification via a QR code.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It effectively mimics the layout and language of legitimate Google Workspace communications and leverages the plausible scenario of requiring MFA for security.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Individuals in administrative roles or those who manage IT services, as they are responsible for dealing with security protocols like MFA and may act quickly to resolve what appears to be a legitimate security concern.

Sharepoint Access Request

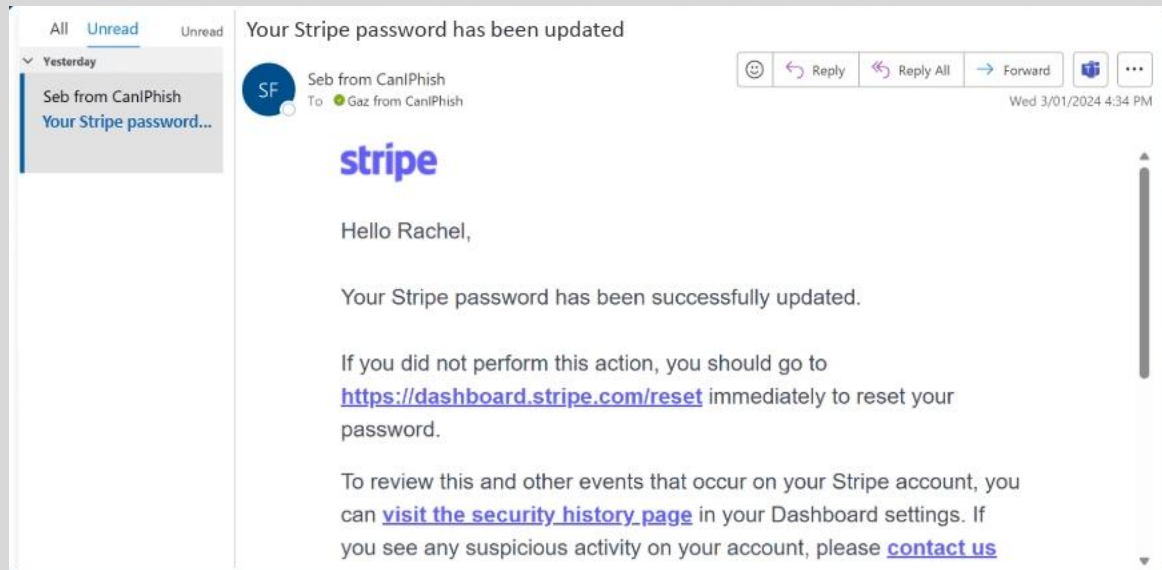
SharePoint is a web-based collaborative platform integrated with Microsoft Office, primarily used by businesses.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is a request for access to a SharePoint resource, providing options to "Accept" or "Decline" and including details of a bogus requester.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It utilizes a common legitimate function of SharePoint, access requests, which employees may regularly encounter. The format is concise and mimics genuine SharePoint notifications, complete with company-specific URLs and names.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees who frequently use SharePoint in their workflows, especially those accustomed to routinely granting such permissions.

Stripe Password Update

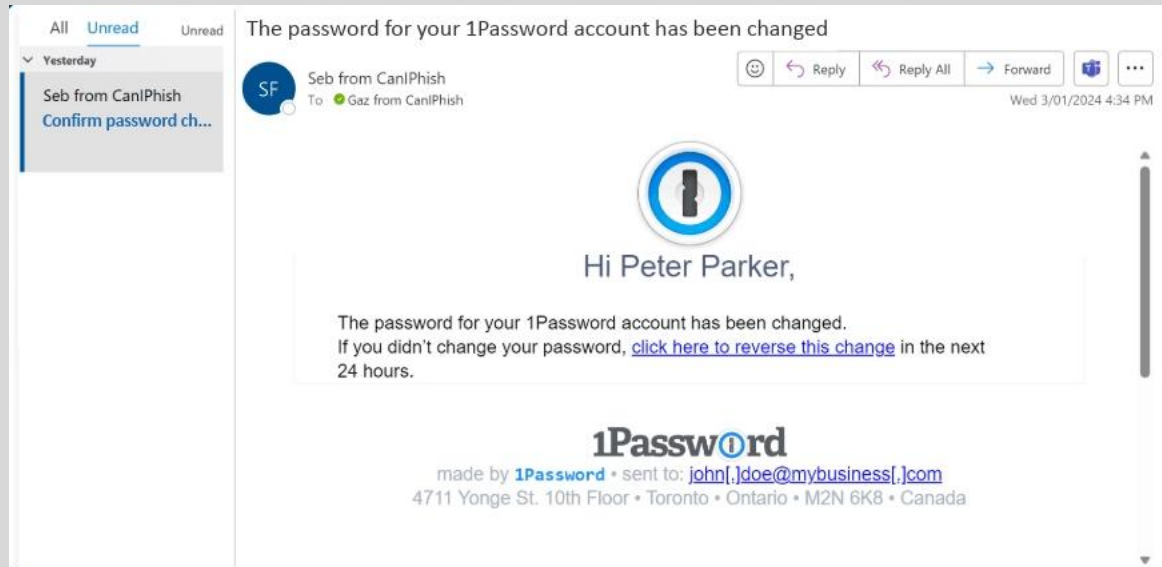
Stripe provides payment processing solutions for online businesses.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is disguised as a Stripe notification informing the recipient that their password has been updated, with a link to reset it if they didn't initiate the change.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It leverages a realistic scenario that could occur in normal operations. It includes detailed instructions mimicking legitimate customer support protocols, and the professional tone blurs the line between authentic and fraudulent.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Stripe users, particularly small business owners, freelancers, or individuals who rely heavily on Stripe. The urgency of a security breach involving finances can cause panic.

1Password Password Change

1Password is a well-known password manager providing secure storage for sensitive information.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email claims to be from 1Password, alerting the recipient that their password has been changed and providing a link to reverse the change.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It creates a sense of urgency and plays on the fear of unauthorized access. The professional layout, complete with a realistic footer containing contact information, mimics legitimate corporate communications.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Users of 1Password, particularly those who panic upon reading about an unauthorized change, making hurried decisions without verification.

Xero Statement

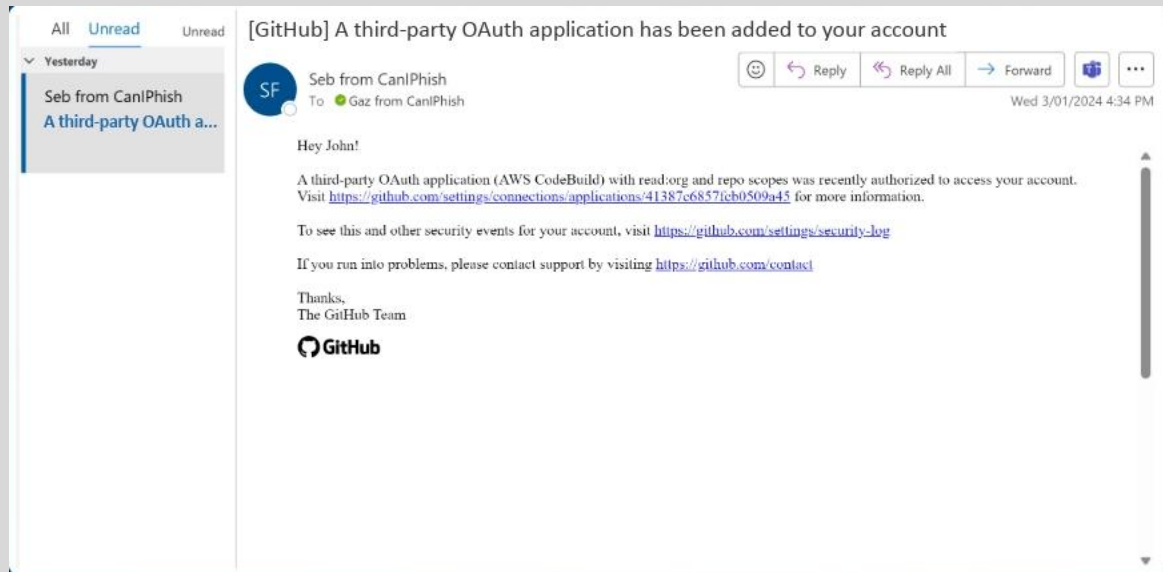
Xero is a cloud-based accounting software for small to medium-sized businesses.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email poses as a notification from Xero, inviting the recipient to download the Contoso Corp Quarterly Profit and Loss Statement.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It cleverly uses a legitimate business scenario—sharing financial documents, that a user might expect. The inclusion of privacy statements, unsubscribe links, and references to common Xero roles adds authenticity.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Business owners, accountants, and administrative staff who regularly use Xero. Direct relevance to their daily operations makes interaction likely.

GitHub OAuth App

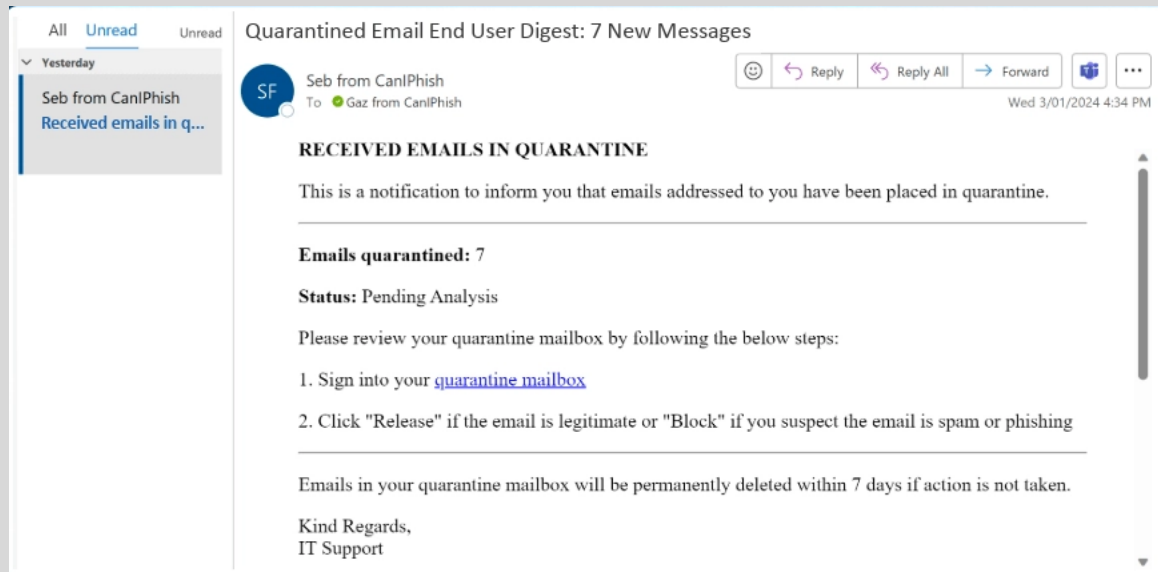
GitHub is a platform for version control and collaboration used by developers.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email imitates a GitHub notification that a third-party OAuth app (AWS CodeBuild) has been authorized, with links leading to phishing pages.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It uses technical jargon familiar to GitHub users and detailed references to OAuth permissions, part of typical workflows. The specific URLs resembling GitHub's domain structure add credibility.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Developers and users who frequently interact with GitHub and third-party applications, especially if they are actively using integrations like AWS CodeBuild.

Quarantined Email

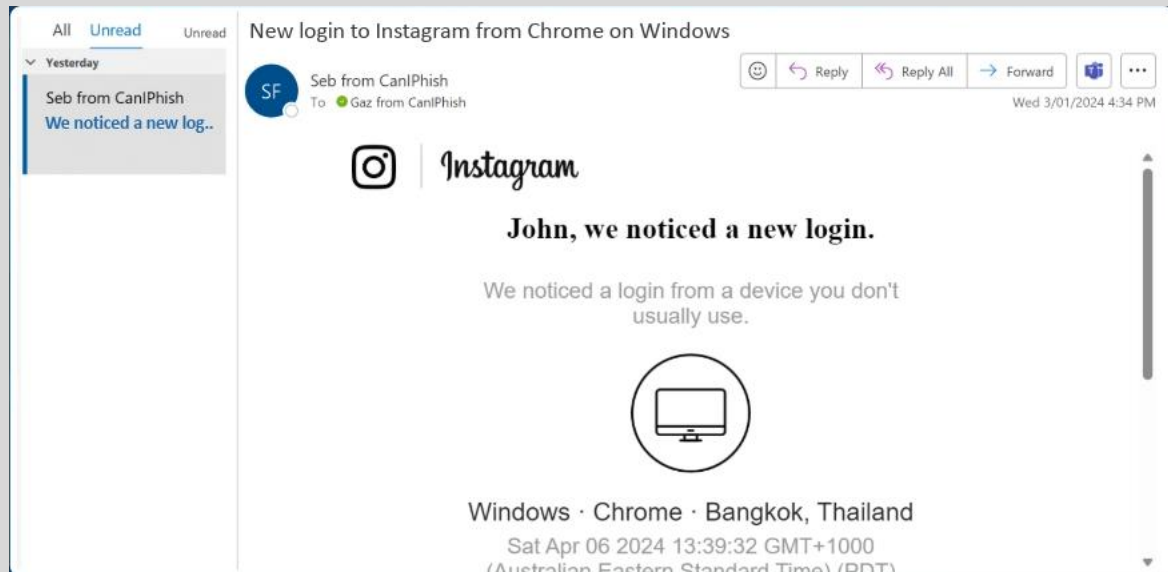
Quarantined emails are set aside by security systems as suspected spam or malware.



- **My assessment of this email:** This phishing email masquerades as a notification from the organization's spam filtering software, prompting employees to sign into their quarantine mailbox.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Checking quarantined emails is routine, making this seem like standard procedure. It injects urgency by stating the user has only seven days to act, rushing them past critical thinking.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** System administrators, particularly those lacking training in detecting phishing. Their familiarity with email security processes can ironically make them less cautious.

Instagram Verification

Instagram is a photo and video-sharing social networking service.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email impersonates a security alert from Instagram about a suspicious login, providing a fake link to secure the account.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It mimics genuine security alerts that platforms send for unusual logins, using specific details such as device type, browser, and location to appear legitimate.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Instagram users vigilant about account security but not familiar with nuanced phishing tactics. The email exploits immediate concern over unauthorized access.

Facebook Verification

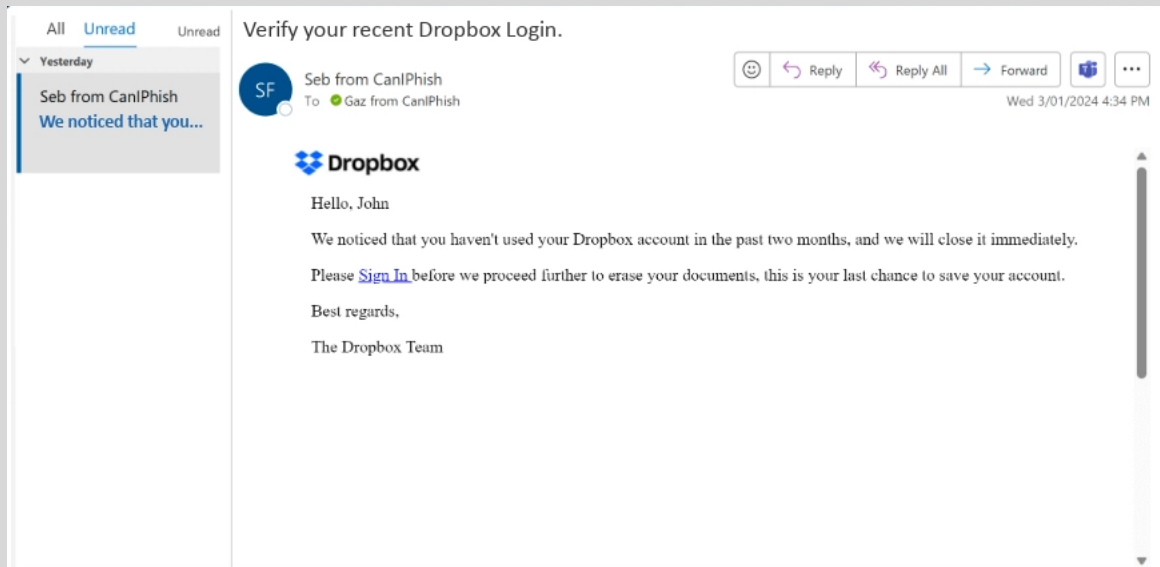
Facebook is a global social networking service.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email poses as an urgent security notification from Facebook about a massive breach, insisting on an immediate password change via a provided link.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It realistically portrays a credible security threat—a scenario Facebook has experienced. It uses technical language and the name of an authoritative figure, tapping into fear and urgency to cloud judgment.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any Facebook user, particularly those not regularly updated on legitimate security practices or those aware of past real breaches.

Dropbox Verification

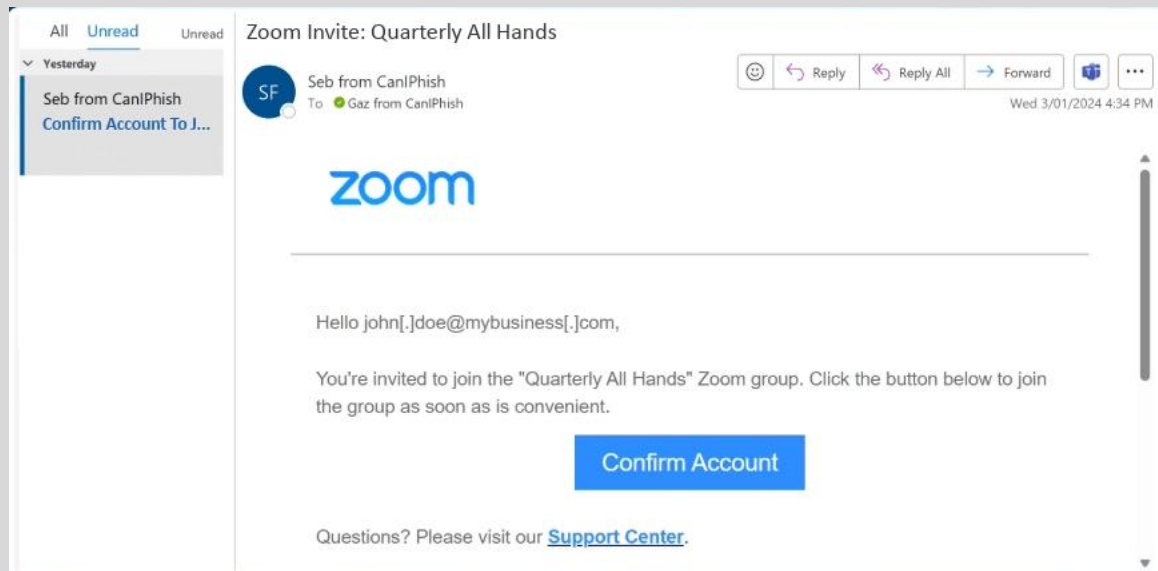
Dropbox is a well-known file hosting service offering cloud storage and synchronization.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email masquerades as an urgent notification asserting the recipient's account has been inactive and is on the verge of closure, pressuring them to sign in via a malicious link.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It uses a plausible scenario of account inactivity leading to closure, a policy some real services follow. The professional tone and concise language mirror legitimate corporate communication.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Individuals using cloud storage like Dropbox for personal or business purposes. The urgency of losing important documents can prompt hasty actions.

Zoom Invite

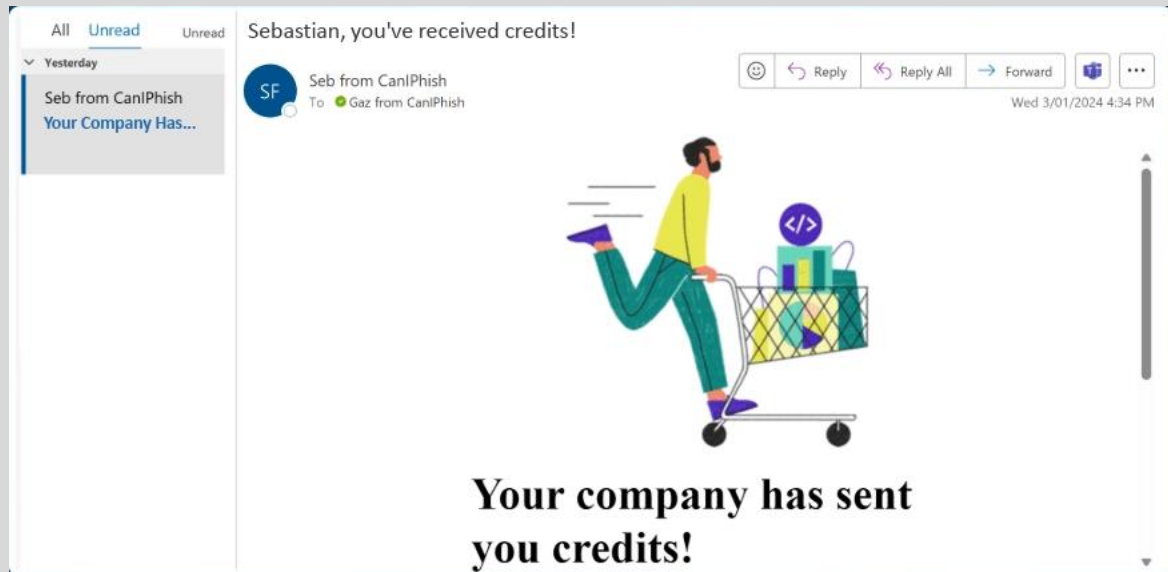
Zoom became a household name during the pandemic, synonymous with work-from-home culture.



- **My assessment of this email:** Adopting Zoom's familiar branding, this email announces a "Quarterly All Hands" meeting and urges users to confirm their account via a fraudulent login page.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Zoom's widespread use across organizations makes this seem routine. Paired with a phony login page and a subtly disguised sender profile, spotting the deception is challenging.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees accustomed to Zoom meetings, both within and outside their organization.

Udemy Free Credits

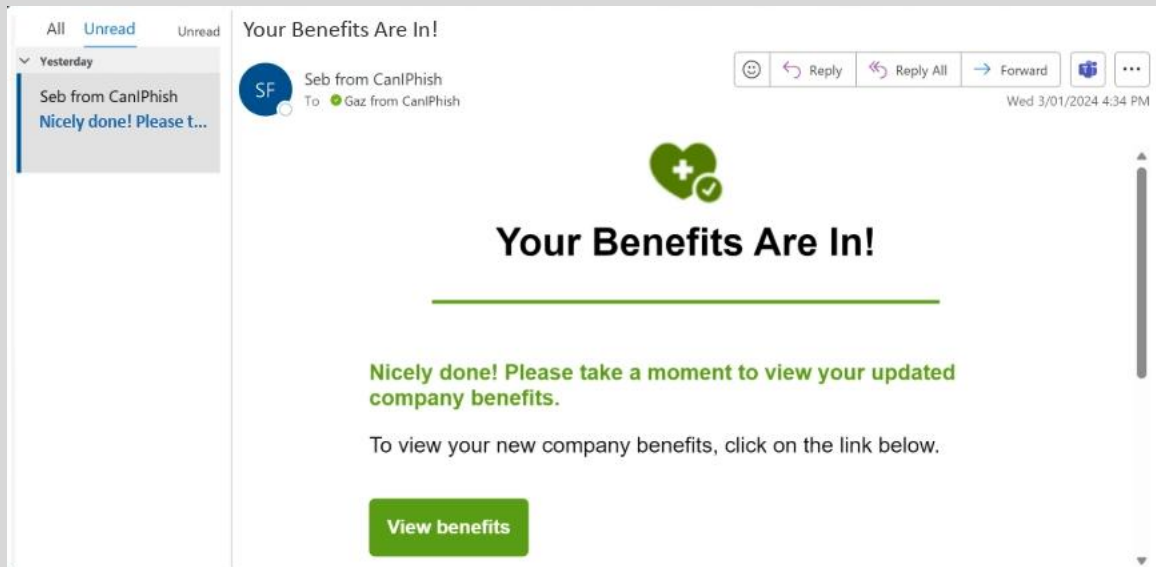
Udemy is a leading online learning platform for professional adults and students.



- **My assessment of this email:** Utilizing recognizable Udemy branding, this email informs employees they must log in to claim USD\$200 credit, the catch is in the login attempt.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Expertly mimicking Udemy's format, it includes a personalized message and a straightforward path to claim credits via a single button.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees in companies that use Udemy for training or offer learning incentives. Familiarity with receiving benefits through Udemy makes the scam more believable.

Bamboo HR Employee Benefits

BambooHR is HR software for small and medium-sized businesses.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email purports to be a notification from BambooHR that company benefits have been updated, encouraging the recipient to click a link to view them.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Its challenge lies in the seemingly harmless invitation to view something as routine as company benefits. The positive tone and professional layout mimic genuine HR software communications.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees accustomed to receiving regular updates about HR matters such as benefits or policy changes. The familiar context exploits routine administrative processes.

Salesforce Password Expiry

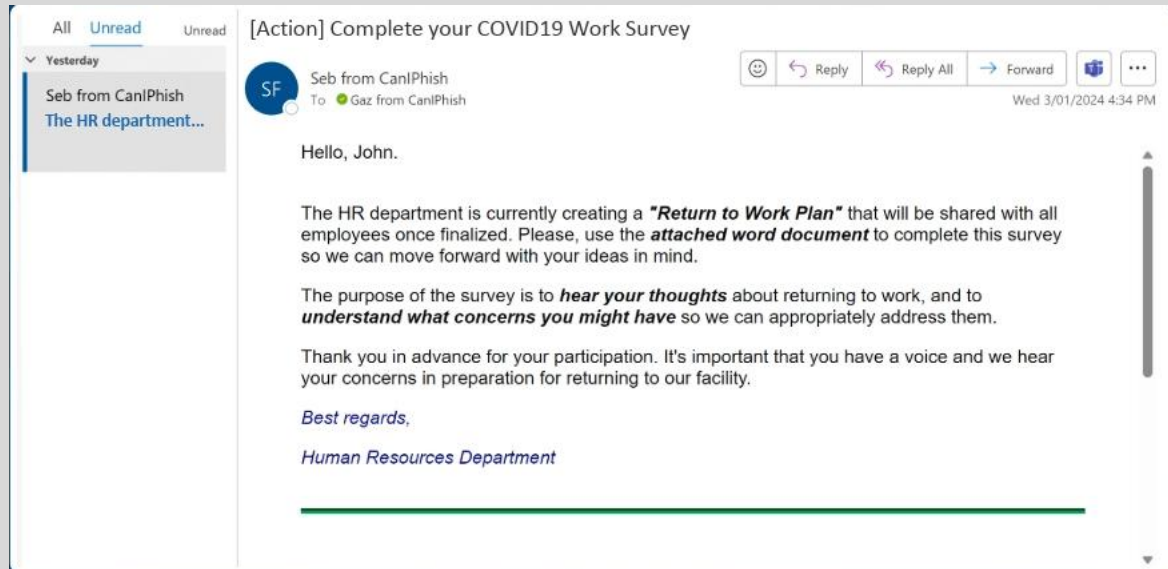
Salesforce is a leading cloud-based CRM software.



- **My assessment of this email:** This phishing email plays the familiar tune of a "password expiring soon" alert, warning users they have three days to reset it via a bogus login page.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** The commonality of legitimate password expiry emails adds to the confusion. Coupled with convincing Salesforce branding, distinguishing this fake from the real deal becomes challenging.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees in organizations that utilize Salesforce. Familiarity with receiving such password communications makes them prime targets.

Return to Work Survey

Scammers exploit global events like COVID-19 to blend malicious emails with legitimate corporate communications.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email urges employees to download and return an attached document framed as a survey for feedback on returning to the office.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** The authenticity is bolstered by personalized content and a lack of obvious red flags. Only a close inspection of the sender's profile reveals its malicious nature.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees in organizations are currently navigating the shift back to office work, especially those who value having their voices heard.

Win An iPhone 15 QR Code

QR code phishing, or "quishing," has increased with the rise in QR code usage post-pandemic.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email, seemingly from HR, promotes a company competition with an iPhone 15 as the prize, all you need to do is scan the QR code.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** An exciting contest combined with the ease of entry via QR code makes this phishing email particularly convincing. Its appearance closely mimics legitimate corporate communications.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees drawn to the thrill of winning, especially tech enthusiasts eager for the latest gadgets.

Lyft Free Rides

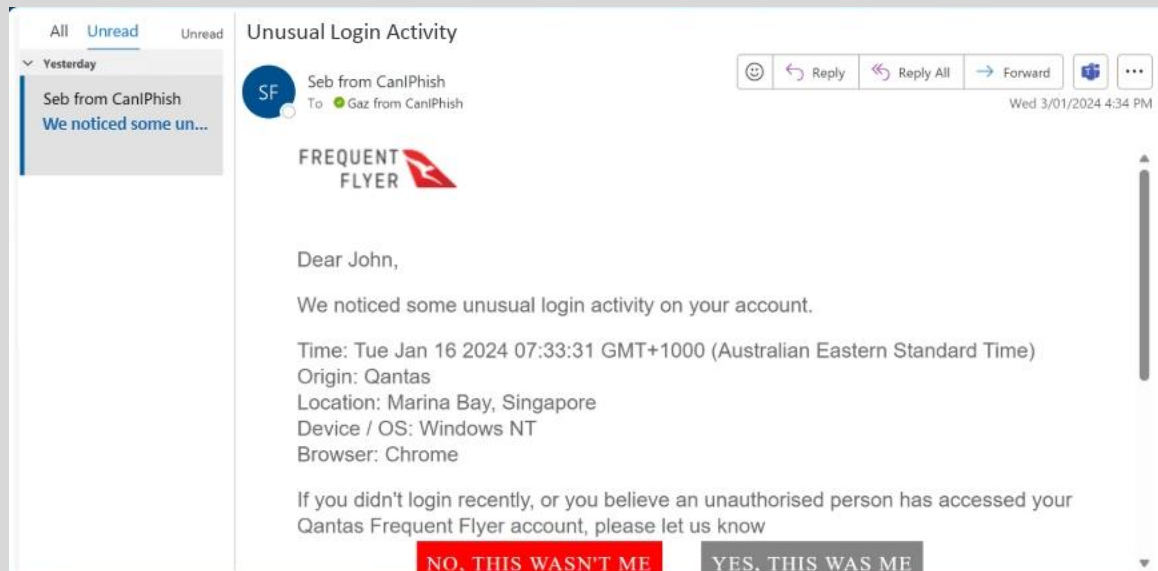
Lyft is an American ride-sharing company.



- **My assessment of this email:** Disguised as a message from HR, this email entices employees with 10 free Lyft rides as part of a company initiative, leading to a prompt for company login credentials.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Blending a typical company incentive scenario with Lyft's branding, it convincingly bypasses suspicion for those not well-versed in spotting deceptions.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees in companies that routinely use Lyft or offer perks like freebies.

Qantas Frequent Flyer

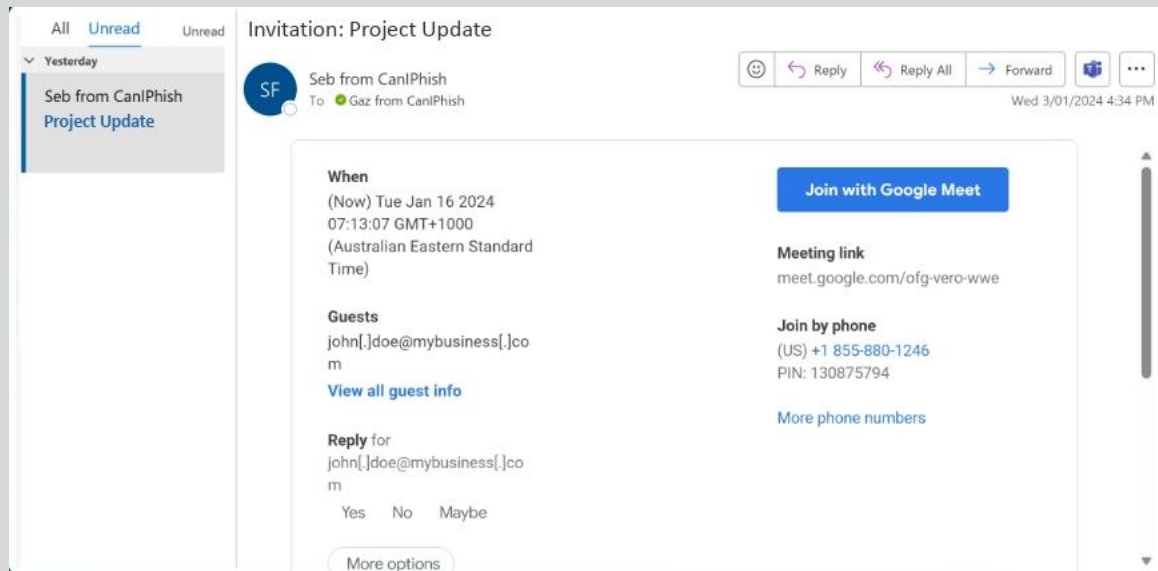
The Qantas Frequent Flyer program is a customer loyalty program offered by Qantas Airways.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email mimics an alert for unusual account activity. Both "No, this wasn't me" and "Yes, this was me" deceptively lead to a fake Qantas login page.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Its severity makes it alarming, potentially triggering panic. In haste to secure their account, employees often overlook the usual checks.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Those personally using Qantas Frequent Flyer, or employees in businesses that do.

Fake Meeting

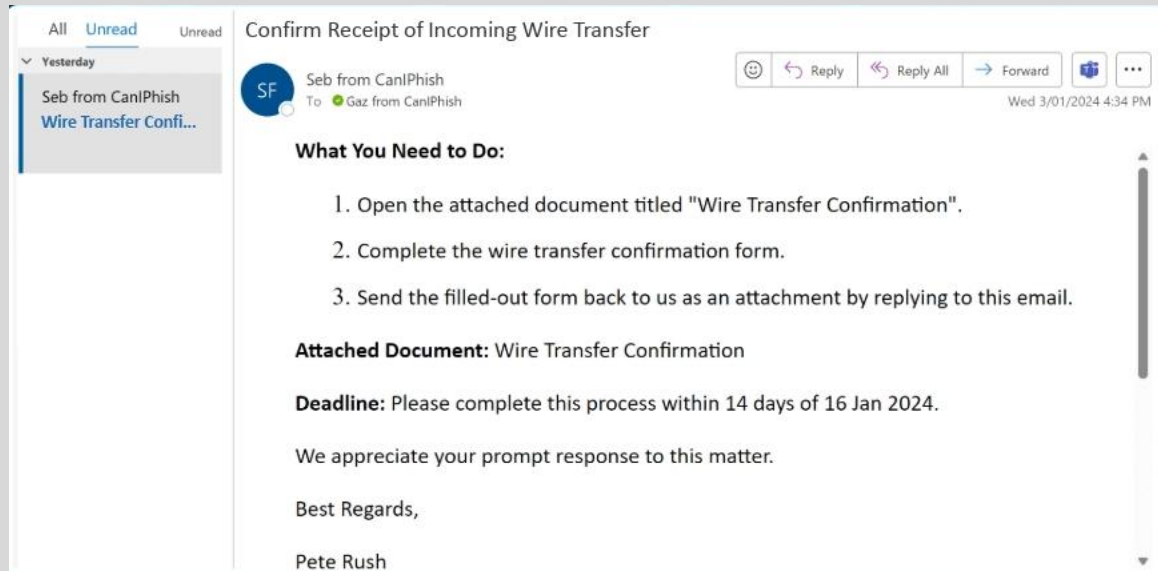
Google Meet is a powerful video conferencing tool.



- **My assessment of this email:** Posing as a Google Meet invite, this email tricks employees into clicking a link that leads to a fraudulent site designed to harvest credentials.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Mimicking a legitimate and familiar format creates urgency with a 'now' timing and includes the employee's email in the body.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Individuals who overlook verifying sender information, and organizations that frequently use Google Meet.

Western Union Wire Transfer

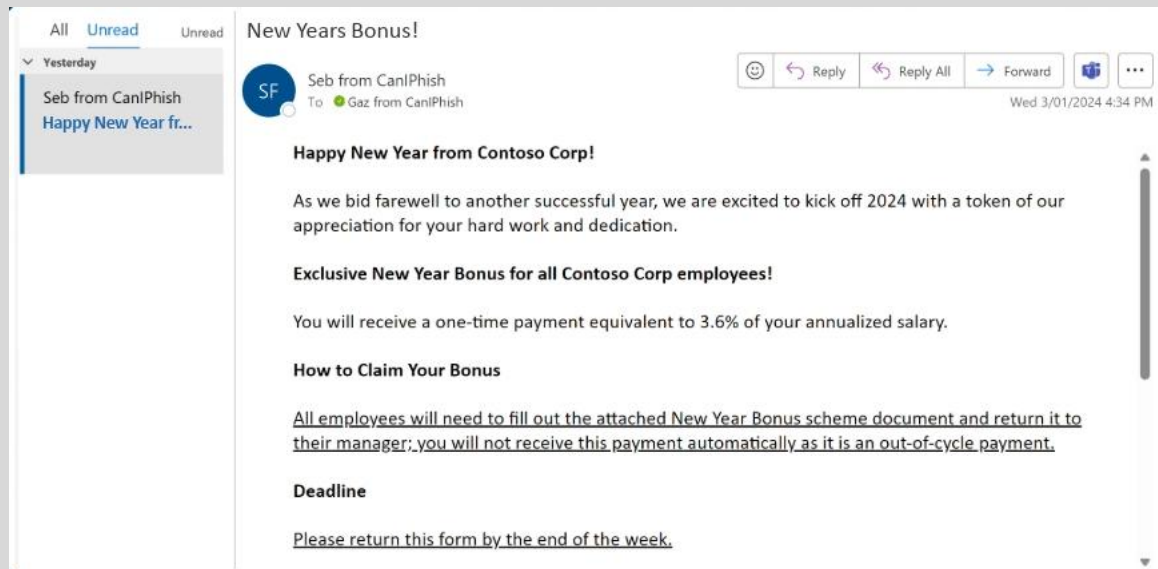
This scam leverages Western Union's reputation and the urgency associated with wire transfers.



- **My assessment of this email:** This deceptive email cunningly impersonates an official Western Union communication, luring the recipient into believing they will receive a substantial sum. It prompts them to confirm receipt by completing an attached document and includes a link to a fraudulent login page.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Its difficulty arises from its expert use of Western Union's trusted reputation and personalized information tailored to the recipient.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Virtually any employee, with risk heightened in organizations that frequently use Western Union for transactions.

New Years Bonus

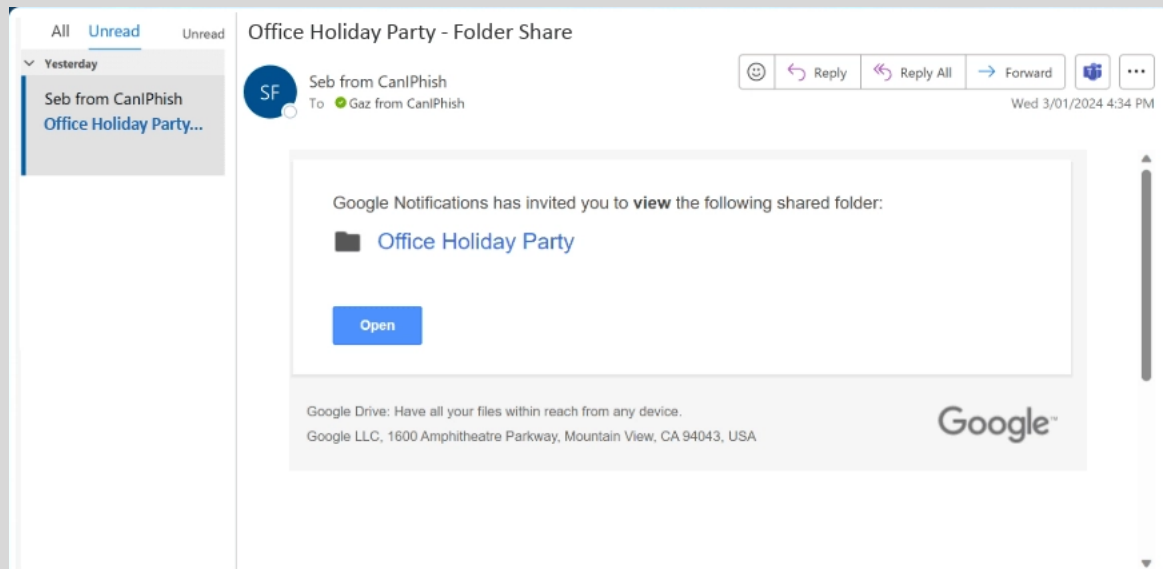
This scam plays on the expectations surrounding end-of-year bonuses.



- **My assessment of this email:** Disguised as an HR announcement, this email tempts employees with a large bonus, luring them to complete a form.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** This text-based email cleverly uses personalized details, creating urgency and authority. Combined with the promise of financial gain, it embodies classic phishing tactics.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees who don't pause to scrutinize authenticity, especially in their eagerness for the bonus.

Office Holiday Party

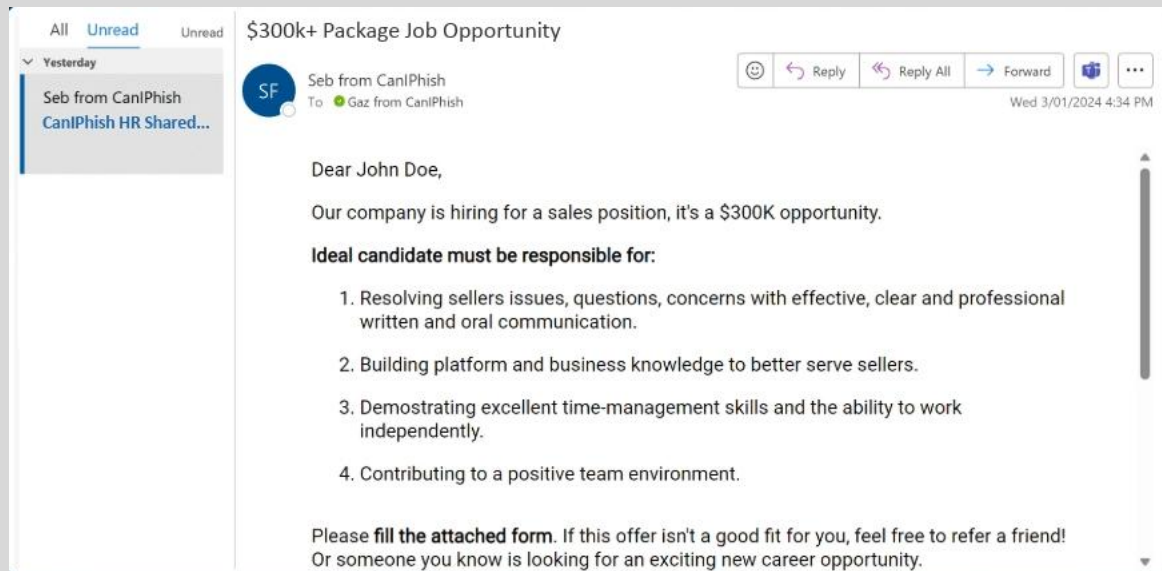
This generic email has no personalization yet still fools many employees.



- **My assessment of this email:** A seemingly innocent email poses as Google Drive, inviting you to an "Office Holiday Party" with a simple "Open" button, leading to a phishing site for Gmail credentials.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** Leveraging Google's trusted brand and our innate curiosity, it contains no personalization. Its simplicity and harmless appearance make it effective.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Curious individuals drawn in by the mention of an office party.

Job Opportunity

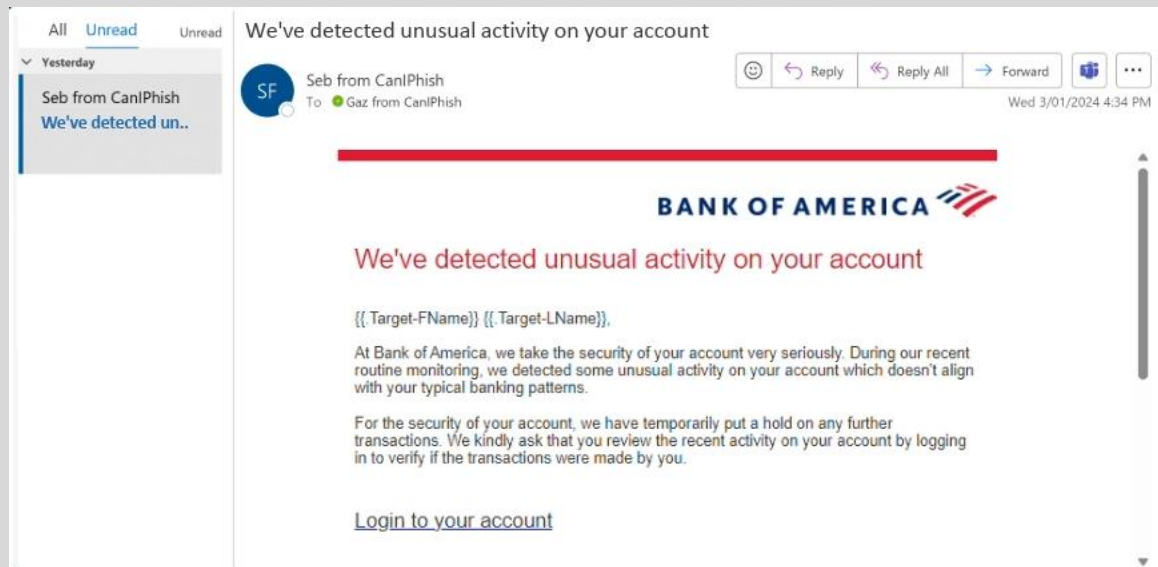
Cybercriminals capitalize on the allure of a high-paying job offer.



- **My assessment of this email:** Disguised as an offer from HR, this email dangles a job with a hefty salary and generic requirements, asking you to fill out and return an attached file.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** The cunning lies in its personalization and simplicity, addressing you by your full name, making it seem credible.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee curious or motivated by financial gain, this has proven extremely difficult to spot.

Bank of America Suspended Account

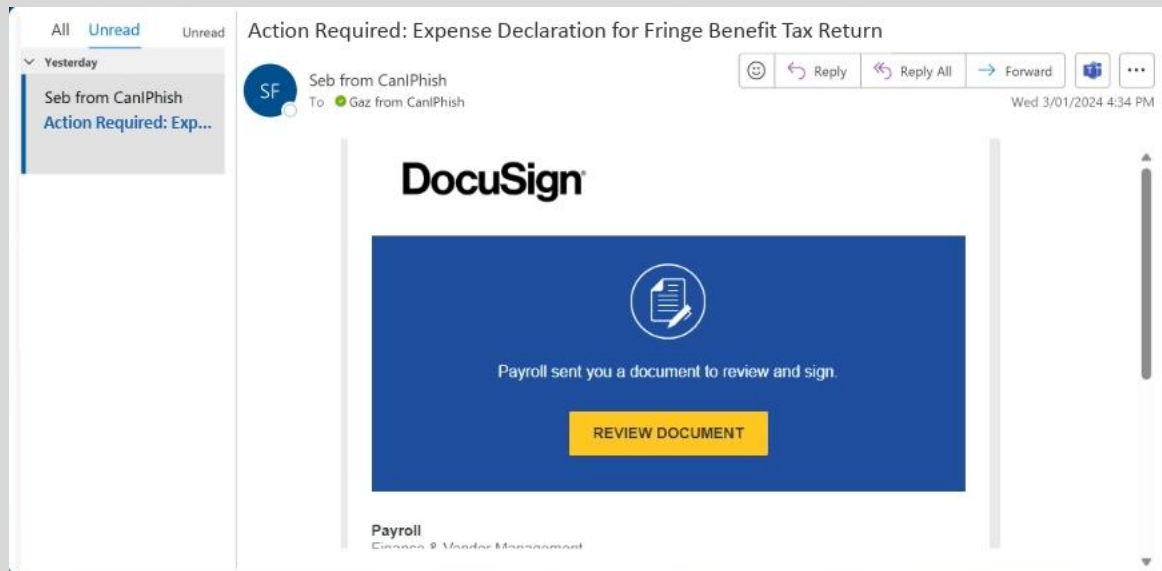
Bank of America is one of the largest financial institutions in the US.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a Bank of America suspended account notification due to unusual activity, enticing the recipient to click a button leading to a phishing website.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It uses a high degree of personalization (first and last names) and can easily mix in with legitimate emails Bank of America periodically sends.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees who use Bank of America, typically a subset of employees located in the United States.

DocuSign Signature Request

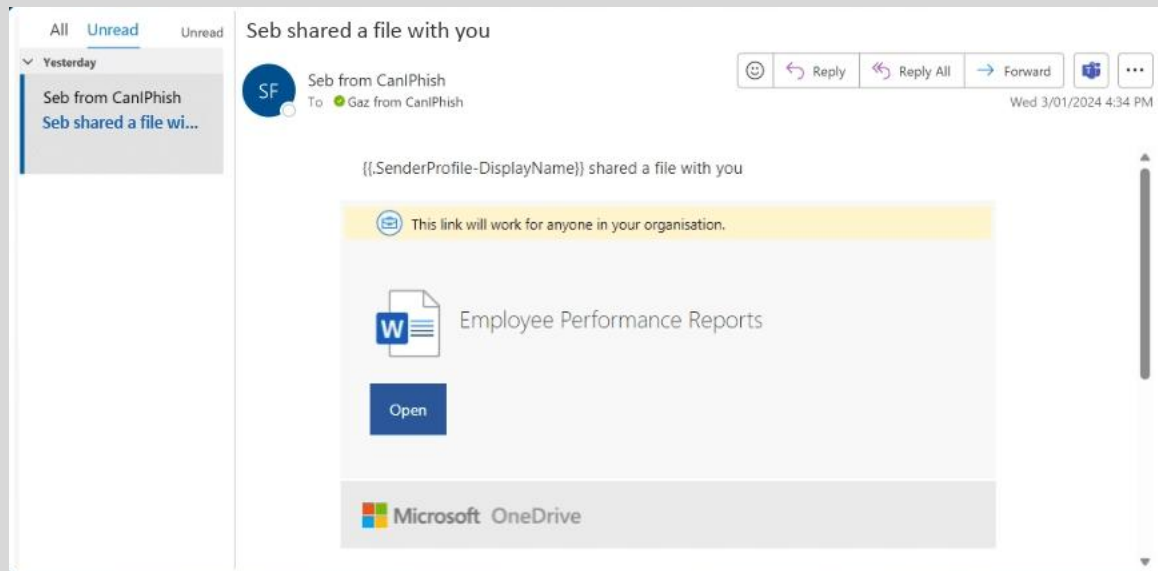
DocuSign is a popular online service for digital agreements.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a DocuSign signature request, asking the recipient to click a link to review and sign a document.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It's not uncommon that DocuSign requests come through at unexpected times, for policies, training, or various actions. Recipients have been trained to expect unsolicited DocuSign emails.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee.

Microsoft OneDrive File Share

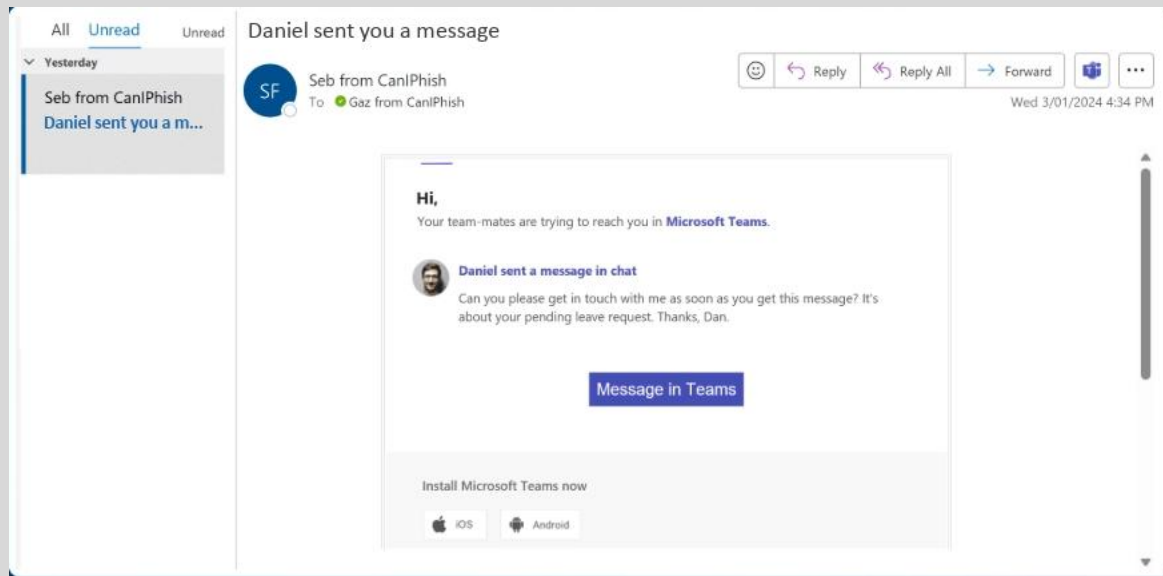
Microsoft OneDrive is a core product within the Microsoft 365 Suite.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a OneDrive file share notification about a Word document relating to employee performance reports, prompting the recipient to click a link.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** While it contains no personalization, it invokes an emotional response, the file has likely been shared by accident and contains sensitive information they'd want to see. A curious recipient will click without proper analysis.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Employees who use OneDrive, but because files are frequently shared with non-Microsoft users, any employee could be susceptible.

Microsoft Teams Missed Message

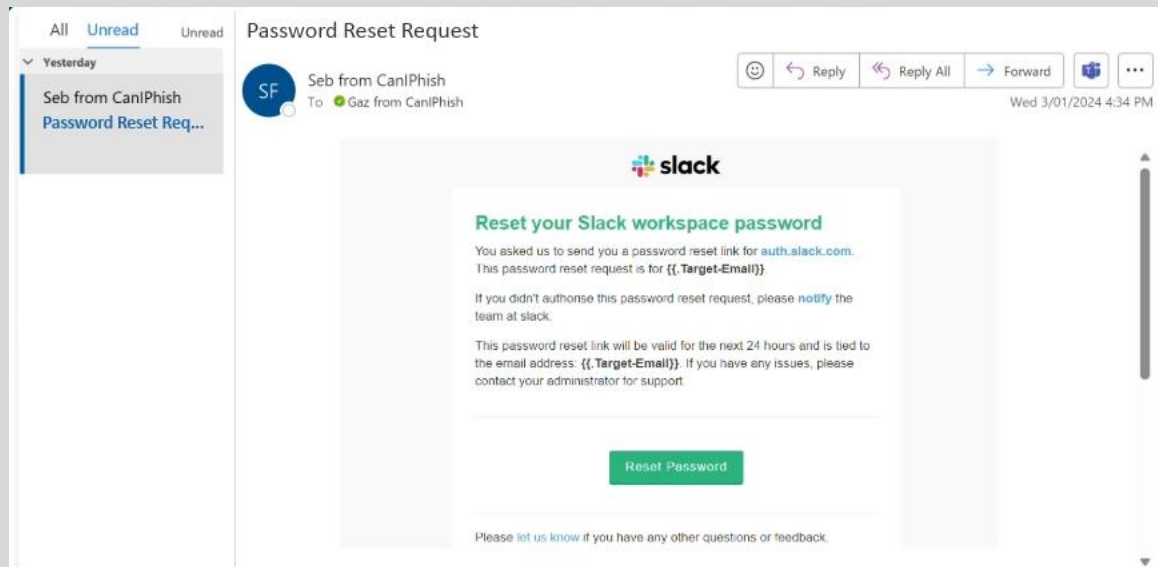
Microsoft Teams is a favorite among large businesses.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a Teams missed message notification about an upcoming leave request, prompting the recipient to message the sender back via a button.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** When someone is away from their desk, it's common to get email notifications from Teams about missed activity. While it contains no personalization, it fits the theme of generalized Teams notifications.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee who uses Microsoft Teams.

Slack Password Reset

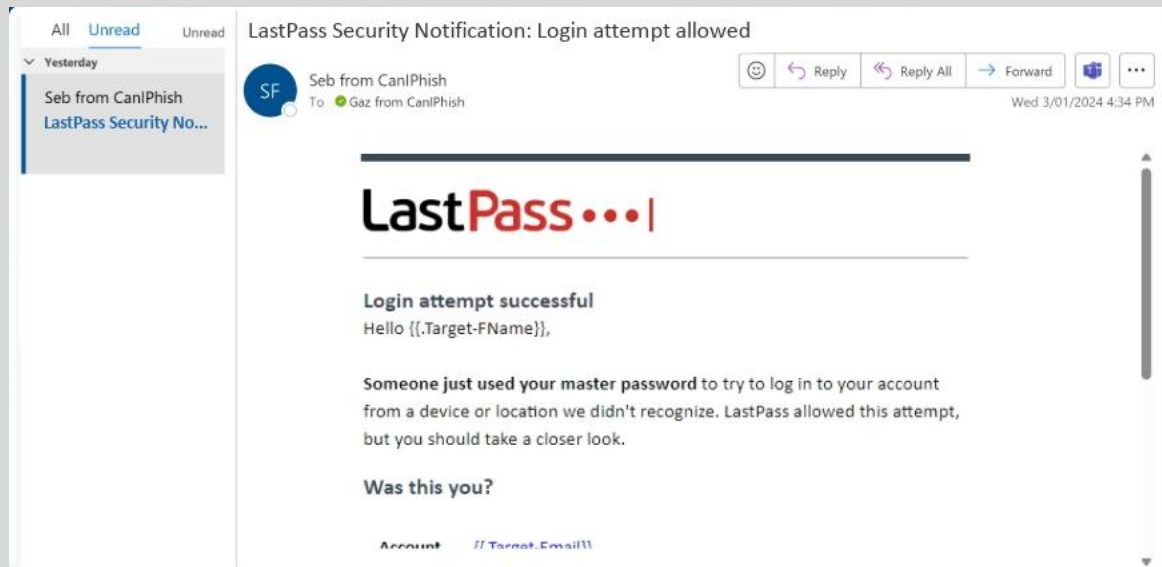
Slack is one of the most popular communication platforms in the world.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a Slack password reset notification, advising that the password is due to expire in 24 hours and a new one needs to be set.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It contains no personalization but relies on urgency to entice immediate action via a phishing link.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee who uses Slack.

LastPass Suspicious Login

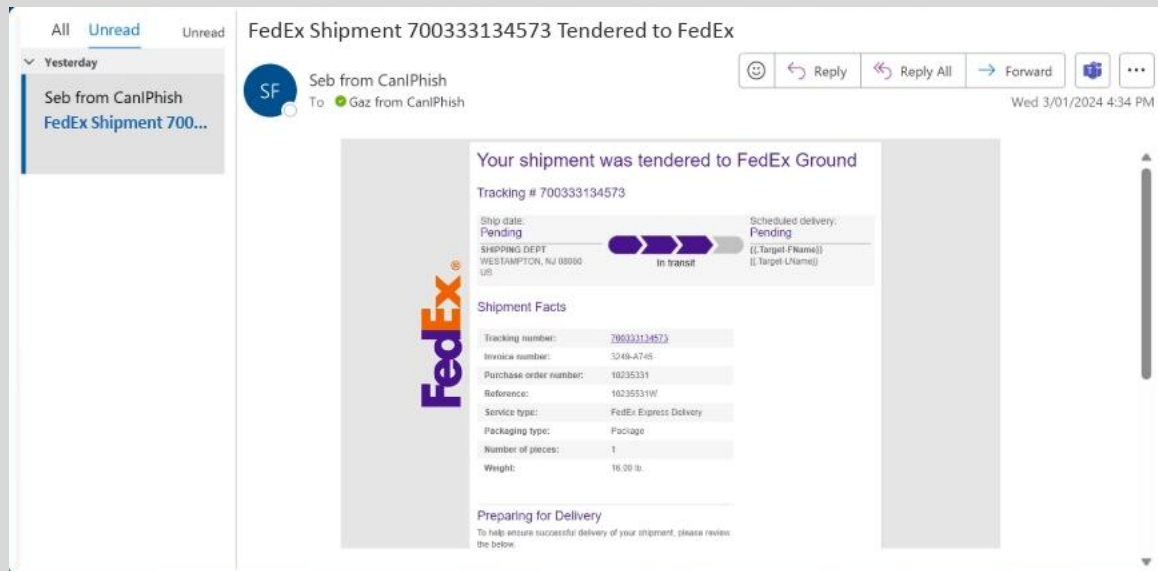
Password managers like LastPass have become popular due to data breaches.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a LastPass suspicious login notification, stating that someone used the master password from an unrecognized location.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** For anyone using a password manager, this is their worst fear, password managers hold the crown jewels. It is designed to invoke a fearful response, causing interaction without critical thinking. Light personalization increases its realistic feel.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee who uses the LastPass password manager.

FedEx Shipment

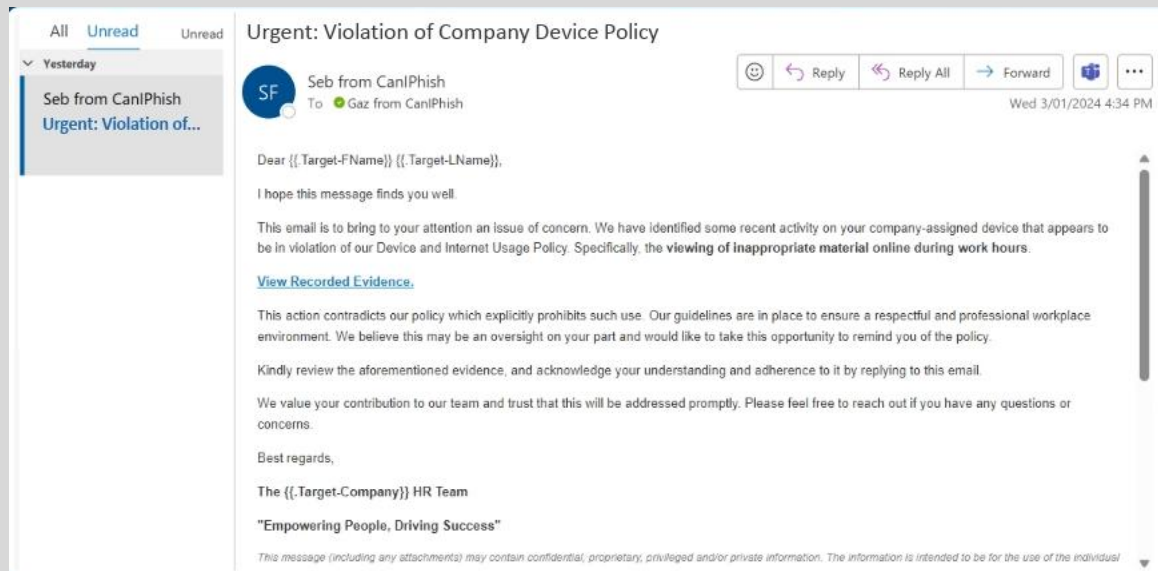
The unexpected nature of delivery notifications makes this phish dangerous.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a FedEx shipment tracking notification, advising that a package is in transit and enticing the click of a tracking link.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It's not uncommon to receive packages without prior notification present, a work gift, or a forgotten delivery. These factors make an unexpected email seem normal. Personalization with the recipient's first name adds to the scam's effectiveness.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any general consumer or employee.

HR Policy Violation

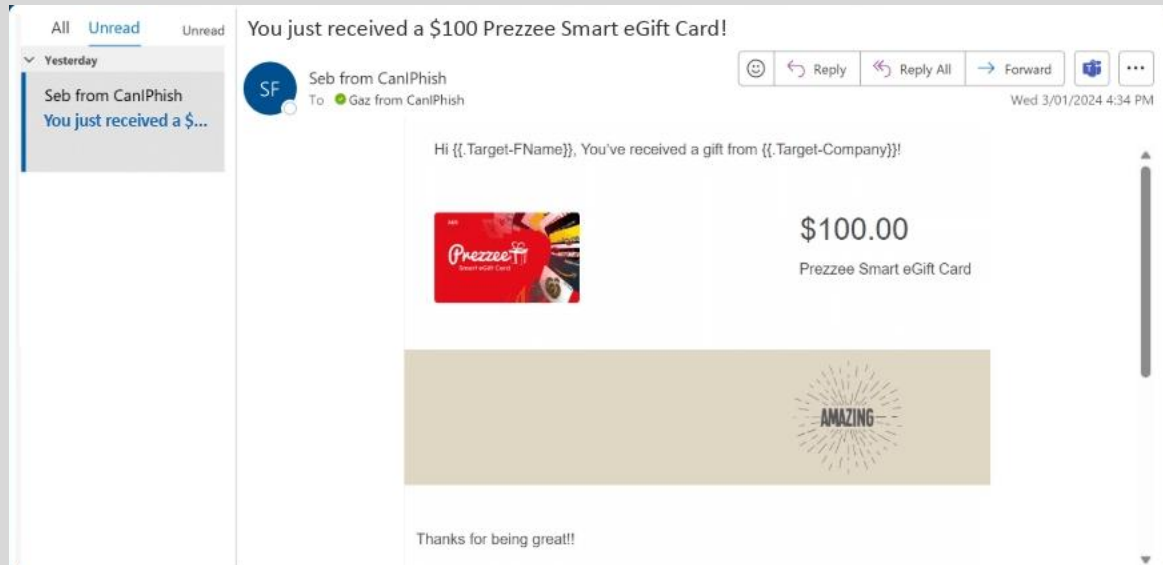
The dreaded email from Human Resources (HR). With an average of 35% of employees compromised, I recommend using this phish with care!



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a notification from the HR team that the employee has violated company policy by viewing inappropriate material on their work computer.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It can send shivers down anyone's spine. The recipient questions what they did, leaving them feeling they need to prepare their defense, which starts with viewing the purported evidence. It contains a phishing link, a phishing attachment, and a high degree of personalization.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Due to its general nature, any employee could fall for it.

Prezzee Gift

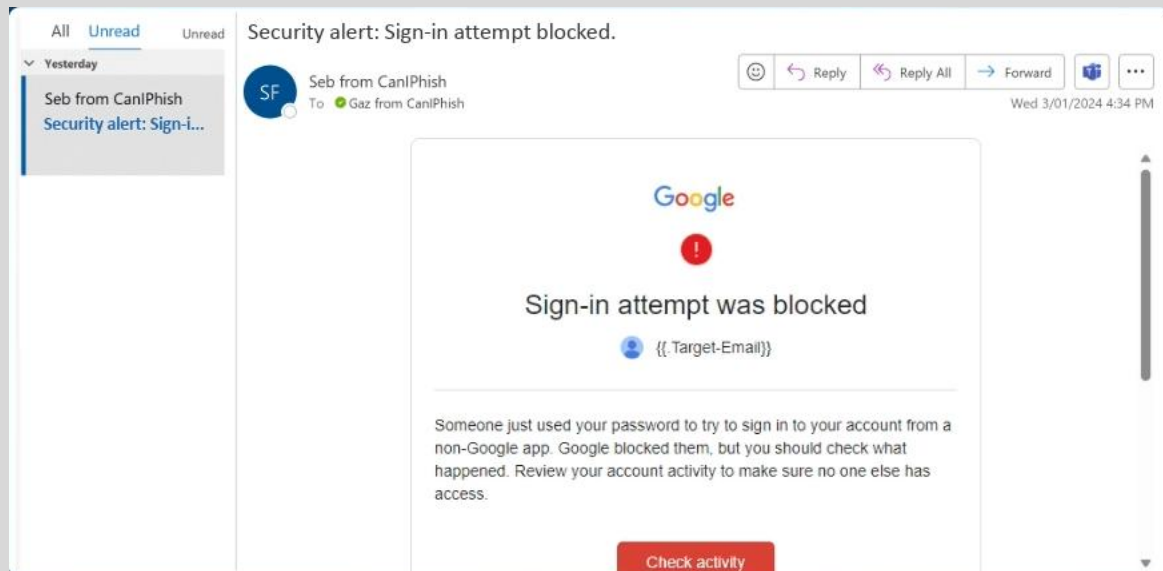
Prezzee is a popular service for sending and managing gift cards.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as Prezzee, appearing as a company-issued gift card provided to the employee due to high performance.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It contains personalization with the employee's first name and company name. It also relies on inciting excitement, which can bypass critical thinking.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee familiar with Prezzee or who views themselves as a high performer deserving of a reward.

Gmail Blocked Login

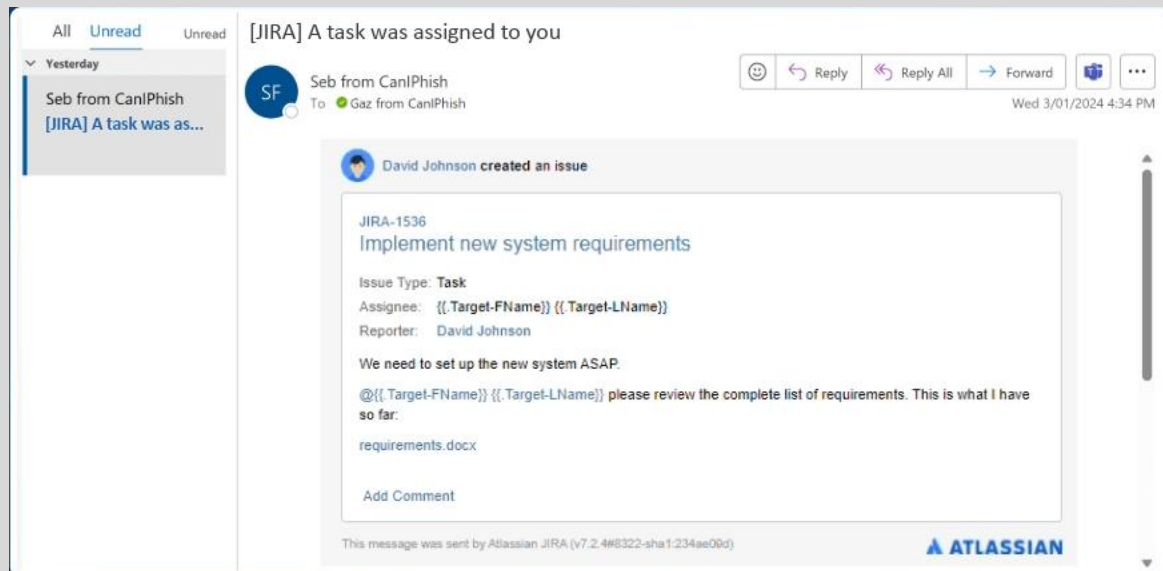
Gmail is an incredibly popular email tool, making it an attractive target.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a Gmail security notification advising that Google blocked a suspicious login and the password may be compromised.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It contains no personalization, but the sheer urgency and fear it sparks is enough to make it difficult. It relies on emotional response without critical analysis.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Anyone who uses Gmail or other Google-provided products. This compromises 38% of employees on average.

Jira Notification

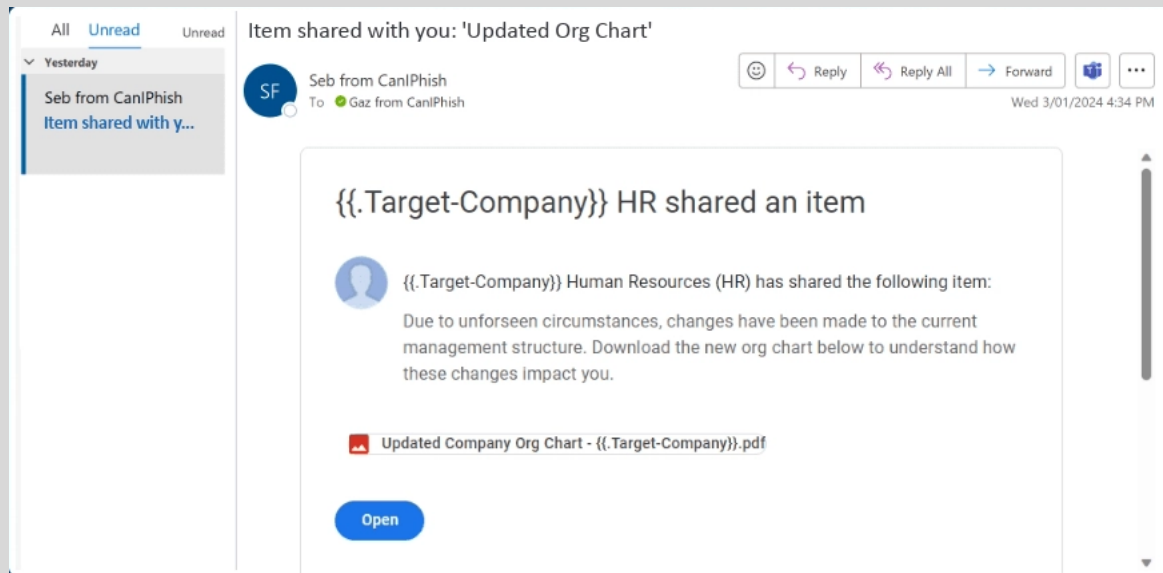
Jira is one of the most popular issue and project tracking tools.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as a Jira notification that the recipient has been assigned a new task.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** It contains a high degree of personalization (first and last name) along with Jira logos, terminology, and transactional language, making it particularly difficult to spot.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Software developers, project managers, product managers, and IT administrators. As these employees typically have elevated access, this email is especially attractive to cyber criminals.

Google Drive File Share

With an average of 54% of employees compromised, this Google Drive scam is the most dangerous of the lot.



- **My assessment of this email:** This email is masquerading as Google Drive, appearing to come from the HR team and enticing individuals to click a link leading to an updated company organizational chart.
- **Why I find this email difficult to spot:** By masquerading as a commonly used service, it easily blends into the mix of daily emails. It introduces urgency by indicating a sudden change has taken place, and it's in the employee's best interest to find out what changed.
- **Who I see as vulnerable to this phish:** Any employee who uses Google Workspace.